

Activity Description The goal of this "adventure" was to prepare for the interview process for a Software Development Internship at Costco Digital Services. The expectations were to demonstrate technical proficiency in C# and .NET, communicate effectively with a hiring team, and show alignment with company values. To prepare for the interview, I practiced using LeetCode and AI-generated mock interviews, while also asking my current managers and coworkers at my WSU internship for peer feedback and coaching.

Technical and Professional Decisions A key decision I made was to focus the majority of my preparation on concepts like API design, the Pillars of OOP, and LINQ optimization. I chose this path assuming a "Digital Services" role would prioritize these for their architecture, but during the interview, I was just asked to build a simple console application.

Contributions While the interview itself was an individual performance, the preparation was a collaborative effort. I worked independently on coding problems, but also for coaching expertise from my connections at WSU to simulate the environment of an interview. This "team-based" preparation provided diverse perspectives on how to frame my previous project experiences, such as my work on the "OceanTown" hackathon game.

Quality Assessment I assess my behavioral performance as excellent. I was able to explain my experiences clearly and connect with the interviewers. However, I over-prepared for complex technical stuff at the expense of the basics of coding. If I were to repeat this, I would balance my study time more effectively between advanced concepts with fundamental implementation. Practicing with basic environment setups and various project templates would have fixed the problems I faced during the coding portion.

Career Alignment This experience moved me significantly closer to my goal of becoming a Full Stack Engineer. It provided a review of my current skill set and showed exactly where my technical gaps are and where my strengths are. The experience with the Costco interview provided the professional experience needed to transition from an academic setting to a major corporate tech environment.